



TIOBE Index March 2026

Programming Language Popularity Rankings and Trends



Based on search engine data across 20+ engines including Google, Bing, Wikipedia, and Amazon



Python Holds #1 at 21.25% but C Surges to #2 with the Largest Gain

Rank (Mar 2026)	Rank (Mar 2025)	Language	Rating	YoY Change
1	1	Python	21.25%	-2.59%
2	4	C	11.55%	+2.02%
3	2	C++	8.18%	-2.90%
4	3	Java	7.99%	-2.37%
5	5	C#	6.36%	+1.49%
6	6	JavaScript	3.45%	-0.01%
7	9	Visual Basic	2.50%	-0.02%
8	8	SQL	2.00%	-0.57%
9	16	R	1.88%	+0.94%
10	10	Delphi/Object Pascal	1.80%	-0.36%
11	24	Perl	1.75%	+1.05%
12	12	Scratch	1.63%	-0.03%
13	11	Fortran	1.45%	-0.25%
14	14	Rust	1.31%	+0.09%
15	15	MATLAB	1.29%	+0.31%
16	7	Go	1.29%	-1.49%
17	17	Assembly language	1.29%	+0.42%
18	13	PHP	1.23%	-0.25%
19	18	Ada	1.10%	+0.25%
20	26	Swift	1.04%	+0.44%

Perl Jumps 13 Spots, R Climbs 7, and Go Drops 9 -- The Biggest Rank Shifts of 2026

GAINERS

Perl

24th → 11th ↑

+13 spots (+1.05%)

R

16th → 9th ↑

+7 spots (+0.94%)

Swift

26th → 20th ↑

+6 spots (+0.44%)

LOSERS

Go

7th → 16th ↓

-9 spots (-1.49%)

C++

2nd → 3rd ↓

-1 spot (-2.90%)

Java

3rd → 4th ↓

-1 spot (-2.37%)

From Lisp at #2 in 1986 to Python at #1 in 2026: How Language Rankings Shifted Over Time

2026	2021	2016	2011	2006	2001	1996	1991	1986
Python 1	3	5	7	8	26	17	-	-
C 2	1	2	2	2	1	1	1	1
C++ 3	4	3	3	3	2	2	2	9
Java 4	2	1	1	1	3	31	-	-
C# 5	5	4	5	7	11	-	-	-
JavaScript 6	7	8	10	10	8	33	-	-
Go 10	11	60	16	-	-	-	-	-
Ada 14	36	25	22	16	18	6	10	3
Lisp 26	34	26	13	14	19	8	4	2

C is the only language to remain in the top 2 across all nine measurement points spanning four decades.

Python Wins Language of the Year 6 Times -- More Than Any Other Language

Hall of Fame Winners

2025 C#	2024 Python	2023 C#
2022 C++	2021 Python	2020 Python
2019 C	2018 Python	2016 Go

Key Stats

PYTHON

6

WINS

2007, 2010, 2018, 2020, 2021, 2024

C#

2

WINS (2023, 2025)

Note: 2017 winner data not available

The Top 4 Languages Hold 49% of the Index: What This Means for Your Tech Stack

1 Python's dominance vs. decline

Leads at 21.25% but posted the largest YoY drop (-2.59%) among top 5

2 C's resurgence

Surged to #2 with +2.02% gain -- strongest absolute gain in the top 5

3 Legacy language revival

Perl (+13 spots), R (+7 spots), Fortran showing surprising resilience

4 Go's sharp fall

Dropped 9 spots from #7 to #16, possibly displaced by Rust in systems programming

5 Concentration risk

Top 4 languages hold 49% of index -- betting on only a few languages carries concentration risk